MENA-OECD INVESTMENT PROGRAMME



- Draft Conference Agenda-

Private Sector Leadership:

The MENA-OECD Business Council and MENA 100 Conference

Manama, Kingdom of Bahrain

- 28 – 29 April 2009 -

Organised by
The MENA-OECD Investment Programme

In Cooperation with
The MENA Centre for Investment, Manama, Bahrain

Mövenpick Hotel Bahrain

MENA Centre for Investment

OECD

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Background: The MENA-OECD Investment Programme is working on two initiatives aimed at private sector development in the MENA region. First, the MENA-OECD Business Council aims at creating a platform for the business community to participate in the regional economic policy dialogue. This initiative is targeted at senior business executives. Second, the MENA 100 Business Plan Competition seeks to foster entrepreneurial activity at the start-up level. This initiative is aimed at a younger audience of leading entrepreneurs.

In order to advance results and network building for both initiatives, a 2-day conference is scheduled for the end of April 2009. The conference will be hosted by the Kingdom of Bahrain and involve participants from throughout the region and the OECD.

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MEETING 1: The MENA-OECD Business Council

Day 1: Tuesday, 28 April 2009

8.30 a.m.	**Registration**
9:00 – 9:30	**Keynote Address**
	Address to participants by representatives of the MENA Centre for Investment & MENA-OECD Investment Programme)
10:00 – 11:00	**Session 1: Proposal on the MENA-OECD Business Council**
	In this session introduces the MENA-OECD Business Council initiative, outlining its objectives, structure and proposed institutional set-up. The panel will discuss the proposal and shape a common position on the Council's activities and thematic focus.
11:30 – 12: 30	**Session 2: Defining the institutional set-up**
	This session focuses on the institutional set-up of the Business Council, including structure, executive board, membership and eligibility criteria.
12:30 – 14:00	**Lunch**
14:30 – 16:00	**Session 3: Next Steps**
	This session outlines the milestones and activities for 2009.
16:30-17:30	**Session 4: Preparatory Session on the Business Day to be held at the MENA-OECD Ministerial Meeting**
	The Business Day at the Ministerial Meeting in November 2009 will be a key activity of the MENA-OECD Business Council.
18:30 – 20:00	**Open Discussion on the Impact of the Financial Crisis on the MENA Region**
	This session will cover (1) Financial Market Supervision and Regulation in the MENA region; (2) Access to Finance for SME's in Times of Crises and limited liquidity; and (3) the Corporate Governance of Banks.
20:30	**Conference Dinner**

Day 2: Wednesday, 29 April 2009

9:00 – 10:00	**Session 1: Background and Objectives**
	In this session the MENA 100 initiative is introduced, with a focus on objectives, timeline and progress to date. The panel will serve to introduce participants and their roles in MENA 100 to each other.
10:30 – 11:00	**Session 2: Outlining the Competition**
	This session outlines the competition process, eligibility criteria, the criteria of selection, the panel of judges, among other topics. The panel will serve to refine and finalize these topics.
12:30 – 14:00	**Lunch**
14:00 – 16:00	**Session 3: Next Steps**
	This session will formulate the remaining milestones and activities in 2009.